The Dolmen Chapter created a Penny Farthing

Entry by Ulster Full Chapter with wheel detail – below

IWG Chairman Joe Laird says...

Where do you start when someone asks you the question, "Well, was it a good weekend?" I am speaking about IWG National Seminar 2015, held this year in the Radisson Blu, Dublin Airport. "Yes" is the quick answer.

There were two years of planning but all too soon, it seemed, the seminar was upon us again. The last few weeks leading up to the seminar are crazy for the host Chapter but we worked on the premise that "hundreds of man hours would ensure that the event would be all right on the night!"

Most people who are involved in running such events know that they don't get to see much of the actual demonstrations themselves. However, other things more than make up for it. The IWG Seminar is probably the happiest seminar in the world – full of Irish humour, Irish welcomes and Irish fun.

Eight years ago I brought a new competition idea to the table called the Chapter Challenge. Over the years there have been many exciting 'challenges' but this year's was the highlight of the seminar for me. The bicycle display in the foyer of the hotel was a sight to behold and rapidly became a worldwide phenomenon. Can we beat that next year? We will certainly try!

For more images from this year's IWG Seminar and information about applying to host the 2016 event, go to www.irishwoodturnersguild.com.

The Editor says...

There are various reasons why people attend seminars, but learning, sharing and having fun are certainly the main ones. The fun aspect was certainly evident at the IWG Seminar. The ribbing and banter – craic – from attendees during and after some of the demos was great and kept us demonstrators on our toes. At times, I was laughing so much I had bellyache – and I heard more than one howl of laughter from other demonstration rooms. It's fair to say that the IWG seminar is one seminar where fun is obligatory, the food is plentiful and it takes a lot of willpower not to partake of the goodies on offer; the learning is a bonus. I jest of course. Learning is important and all the people I spoke to insisted that they had gleaned much from the seminar.

There is something wonderfully different about the IWG Seminar. The combination of fun and learning and the closeness of the participants, who extend such a warm welcome to newcomers, gives it the feel of a big extended family. It's unique. If you ever get the chance to go, please do so. You will be warmly welcomed and I am sure you will have a lot of fun. ●

There was a warm welcome – and much merriment – at this year's IWG Seminar

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